Mule Palm

× Butiagrus nabonnandii (also listed as Butiagrus nabonnandii, X Butiagrus nabon

Family: Not stated Also known as: —

GARDENS Rockery: 7 **TOTAL 7**



Summer / form
Library candidate

Not available

Fall color
Not available

Not available

Flower
Not available

Not available

Leaf close-up
Not available

QUICK FACTS & PLANTING

Type: Tree
Evergreen/Deciduous: Evergreen
Mature size: 20–40 ft (sources range 15–20 ft to 30–40 ft). **Open:** Mature height range varies; no tight three-source agreement. × 15–20 ft. Confirmed range.
Hardiness / Zone 8a: Suitable for Zone 8a (marginal to reliable). Hybrid of Butia and Syagrus. Cold hardy to approximately 10–14°F once established. Sources list Zones 8a–11. Performs in southern Georgia and Gulf Coast. Faster growth than pure Butia. Restart pass (2026-10-13): Regional sources confirm hybrid hardiness. Existing notes stand.
Sun: Full sun.
Water: Medium. Prefers well-drained soil. Drought tolerant once established.
Soil: Well-drained. Adaptable (sandy, clay, loam).
Growth rate: Not stated
Not stated
Planting:
Siting: Plant in full sun in well-drained soil. Water regularly until established. More cold hardy and vigorous than pure Queen Palm. Suitable as specimen or tropical accent. Minimal pruning.
Soil prep: Well-drained. Adaptable (sandy, clay, loam).
Depth/spacing: Not stated
Season: Not stated
Establishment: Not stated

ORIGIN, CHARACTERISTICS & HEALTH

Origin / native: Natural and intentional hybrid between Pindo Palm (Butia) and Queen Palm (Syagrus). Named for Paul Nabonnand (early 20th century French horticulturist). Sterile or nearly sterile.
Form / habit: Evergreen palm. Solitary trunk. Arching pinnate fronds. Faster growth than Butia. Lush, coconut-like appearance.
Foliage: None (evergreen).
Flowers / fruit: Not stated
Bark / stem: Single trunk. Younger plants may retain leaf bases and fiber.
Not stated
Health:
Health notes: Generally low issues when drainage is good. No serious problems uniquely stated. Cold damage possible below 10–14°F depending on individual and establishment. **Open:** Specific Zone 8a health and cold performance data is thin beyond general hardiness claims.
Not stated
Additional:
- Hybrid of Butia and Syagrus. - Faster growth than pure Pindo Palm. - Nearly sterile (few viable seed). - Lush arching fronds. - Cold hardy for a feather palm.